

principal, rate of return, and number of years. If you focus on finding a career with high earning power and invest in growing that career, you can get to FI faster.

Action Steps

1. Write down five problems or annoyances in your everyday life.
Do other people have these same problems? What product or service could you develop that would add value to others by addressing these issues?
2. Meet with your boss to establish clear expectations and goals for your position.
3. Identify one skill you could obtain in the next year that would increase your value to your employer by at least 10 percent.
Start developing it.
4. Develop a specific routine to keep your employer informed of your achievements (e.g., weekly or monthly e-mail, a quarterly meeting, etc.) and put it on your calendar today.
5. Consider other negotiating points if your employer can't pay you more or if making more money isn't your primary need. Will your employer pay for your cell phone or car? Can you negotiate the ability to work from home or work flexible hours?